



CALL FOR ABSTRACTS

Social Networks and Health: Reciprocal Interdependencies

Joint conference of the Sociological Network Research Section of the German Sociological Association (DGS), the German Society for Medical Sociology (DGMS), and the Social Networks and Health Working Group (DGNet)

DATE

23–24 February 2027

VENUE

Martin Luther University Halle-Wittenberg
Steintor-Campus, Halle (Saale), Germany

SUBMISSION DEADLINE

26 November 2026

Health and illness are not merely individual conditions but are deeply embedded in social relationships and network structures. Social networks shape health behaviours, trajectories of illness, healthcare utilisation, and psychosocial well-being. At the same time, health events and health conditions can affect the structure, composition, and dynamics of social networks. Health and social networks are therefore mutually interdependent, yet research has often examined only one direction of this relationship.

The conference focuses on this reciprocal relationship and invites theoretical, methodological, and empirical contributions that explicitly conceptualise and analyse health as a network-related phenomenon. It aims to bring together current research approaches, foster interdisciplinary exchange, and advance our understanding of the role of social networks in health inequalities, prevention, healthcare, and life-course processes.

TOPICS OF INTEREST

- Social networks as resources or risks for physical and mental health
- Network mechanisms in the transmission of health behaviours, stress, emotions, or knowledge
- Effects of illness, disability, or care needs on network structures and relationship quality
- Social support, social control, and social isolation in the context of health
- Social networks and health inequalities, for example by socioeconomic position, gender, migration background, or age
- Digital networks, social media, and health
- Social network methods in health and medical sociology
- Longitudinal and life-course perspectives on social networks and health
- Network-based approaches to intervention, prevention, and healthcare

The conference welcomes researchers at all career stages. We particularly encourage submissions that introduce innovative theoretical perspectives or methodological developments.

SUBMISSION

Contributions may be submitted for either an oral presentation or a poster presentation. Both formats may be presented in English or German. The **Best Poster Award** will be presented to the highest-rated poster at the conference.

Please submit an abstract of 300–400 words, including the title, author name(s), and institutional affiliation(s), by **26 November 2026** to philip.adebahr-maskow@soziologie.uni-halle.de and krueger@wiso.uni-koeln.de. Please indicate in your submission whether you would prefer an oral or poster presentation and whether you intend to present in English or German.

ORGANISATION

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SEKTION MEDIZIN
UND GESUNDHEITS
SOZIOLOGIE DGS



DGNET

AK SOZIALE NETZWERKE UND GESUNDHEIT

DGMS

Deutsche Gesellschaft für
Medizinische Soziologie